ALASKA INTERIORS

PROJECT MANAGEMENT SOFTWARE & TOOLING REVIEW

Form ID: **OPS-IT-2026**
Target: **alaska.co.nz**

STAFF MEMBER NAME:
e.g. John Doe

CURRENT ROLE / JOB TITLE:
e.g. Site Manager / Project Manager

PRIMARY REGION / PROJECT SITE:
e.g. Auckland Commercial / Christchurch

COMPLETION DATE:
September 2026

Alaska is reviewing software provisioning across commercial projects to ensure everyone has the exact tools they need. You are currently provisioned with **Microsoft Project Plan 3** (designed for full desktop scheduling). We are evaluating which staff require this heavy desktop client, versus the modern **Planner Plan 1** interface accessible directly inside Microsoft Teams and your web browser.

PLANNER PLAN 1 (BROWSER & TEAMS)	PROJECT PLAN 3 (HEAVY DESKTOP CLIENT)
Designed for Team Collaboration: • Interactive Gantt Timeline views directly in Microsoft Teams. • Kanban boards, task lists, checklists, and grid views. • Setting task dependencies (predecessors & successors). • Attaching photos, specs, and status progress from mobile or iPad.	**Designed for Dedicated Schedulers:** • Installs the standalone `Project.exe` app on desktop PC. • Authoring complex `.mpp` files, tender critical paths, and baseline variance calculations. • Advanced resource leveling across multi-project portfolios.

1. Do you currently launch or require the standalone Microsoft Project desktop software (`Project.exe`) installed on your PC?

- ☐ **Yes — I actively open and build schedules in the Project desktop app.**
  Requires dedicated desktop software installed on your local computer.
- ☐ **No — I only interact with tasks and timelines via Microsoft Teams, web browser, or mobile.**
  Does not require the desktop application.
- ☐ **I rarely or never open Microsoft Project or Planner.**
  My daily tracking is handled via other platforms (e.g., CATProjects, Excel).

2. **What best describes your primary responsibility with project schedules?**

- [ ] **Schedule Author / Lead Planner:** I am responsible for generating initial tender programmes, critical path logic links, and updating baselines.
- [ ] **Task Collaborator / Site Manager:** I view milestones, check task dates, update completion percentages, and manage day-to-day site boards.
- [ ] **Viewer Only:** I reference timeline milestone dates created by others for high-level awareness.

3. **Which software platform is your primary tool for managing trade delivery and contract timelines?**

- [ ] **CATProjects / CATPlan (Construction Software Ltd)**
- [ ] **Microsoft Project Desktop (`.mpp` files)**
- [ ] **Microsoft Teams Planner / Task Boards**
- [ ] **Microsoft Excel / Other**

4. **If your license was adjusted to Planner Plan 1 (retaining full Teams Gantt views, boards, checklists, and dependencies, but without the desktop `Project.exe` app), how would this affect your work?**

- [ ] **No negative impact:** Teams Gantt timeline views and task boards provide everything needed for my role.
- [ ] **Unsure / Willing to Test:** I would like to trial Planner Plan 1 to confirm it fits my site workflow.
- [ ] **Negative impact:** My role strictly requires the desktop application (please provide details below).

If you require the desktop client, please specify which specific functions (e.g., baseline variance, multi-project resource leveling) you rely on...